

S04-L1 — The Four Collector Typologies and the Latin American Collector Up Close

Summary

Week four of the course leaves behind the work and the deal to return to the person doing the buying. This first entry proposes a framework of four collector typologies, the passionate collector, the decorator, the investor, and the social collector, understood not as pure categories but as motivations that coexist in different proportions within the same client. The framework is illustrated with two figures from contemporary Latin American collecting who show, from opposite ends, how passion for collecting can scale into institution-building: Eduardo Costantini, whose acquisition of the Daros Latinamerica collection in December 2025 doubled MALBA's holdings, and Jorge M. Pérez, whose gift of works to the Pérez Art Museum Miami that same month illustrates a different pattern of collecting with public reach. The entry closes with three additional axes for reading the Latin American collector up close: the family structure behind a purchase decision, the city where the collector lives and its institutional density, and the trust built by negotiating in Spanish.

1. A framework of motivations, not fixed compartments

Sales literature on collecting commonly distinguishes four dominant motivations behind an art purchase: intellectual and emotional interest in the work and its context (the passionate profile), the search for a piece that solves a concrete decorating need (the decorator profile), the expectation of value appreciation over time (the investor profile), and the pursuit of belonging or visibility within a social or institutional circle (the social profile). None of the four motivations operates in isolation in practice, most clients blend several in shifting proportions depending on the work, the moment, and the conversation. The framework's teaching value lies not in classifying a person once and for all, but in giving whoever advises them a vocabulary for hearing which motivation carries the most weight in any given exchange and adjusting the kind of information they offer accordingly.

2. The passionate collector scaled into an institution: Eduardo Costantini

[Eduardo F. Costantini, an Argentine businessman and founder of the Museo de Arte Latinoamericano de Buenos Aires, announced in December 2025 the acquisition of the Daros Latinamerica collection, based in Zurich, a group of 1,233 works by 117 artists](#) that includes pieces by Doris Salcedo, Carlos Cruz-Diez, and Jesús Rafael Soto, among other central names in modern and contemporary Latin American art.¹ The deal, verified against MALBA's own institutional source, extends a pattern of activity documented for Costantini since 2023, including the incorporation of works by eleven Latin American artists announced by the museum in November 2025 through acquisitions and donations.² MALBA is, according to its own institutional page, an organization whose collection was born directly from its founder's personal acquisitions program, which makes Costantini a textbook case of the passionate collector taken to his fullest expression, the kind whose private collection ends up generating and sustaining a public institution built to last.³

3. The collector with social and institutional reach: Jorge M. Pérez

[Pérez Art Museum Miami announced in December 2025 the gift of 82 works from Jorge M. Pérez's personal collection, with documented emphasis on Latin American art and work from the African diaspora](#), a gift reaffirmed publicly through the long-standing relationship between Pérez and the institution that bears his name.⁴ Pérez is, per the museum's own institutional documentation, founder of El Espacio 23 and a historic donor to PAMM, with the public relationship reaffirmed in 2025 itself through programming tied to the gift.⁵ Pérez's case illustrates a distinct variant of the passionate motivation, one in which building a legacy and social visibility inside one's own city's institutional ecosystem operates as an added layer on top of genuine interest in the work, a pattern completed by the donor's own name appearing on the receiving museum's facade.

4. The Latin American collector up close: family, city, and language

Three variables beyond individual typology prove useful for anyone advising Latin American collectors in New York. The first is the family structure of the purchase decision: [Isabel and Agustín Coppel build their collection, CIAC, as a joint project that connects to institutional activity in New York, including a collaboration with Americas Society on the Lilia Carrillo exhibition open since May 2026](#), and the couple were jointly honored at El Museo del Barrio's gala in

May 2026.⁶ A similar pattern of collecting organized around a family foundation appears with Amalia Amoedo, whose Fundación Ama Amoedo has maintained an active partnership since 2026 with New York's ISCP for residencies for Argentine artists.⁷ The second variable is the city of residence: within the ecosystem surveyed by this course, Miami holds a particularly dense network of private collections, foundations, and museums tied to Latin American collectors, as Pérez's own case shows,⁴ while New York holds the greatest institutional network for Latin American art through MoMA, The Met, the Guggenheim, El Museo del Barrio, and Americas Society.⁸ The third variable, language preference, carries no verifiable public metric and is documented here as a professional-practice observation drawn from the course itself, not as a claim sourced externally.

For the conversation with clients

- Before presenting a work, identify which motivation dominates the specific conversation, without assuming a client who opens by talking about investment return can't end up deciding out of affection for the work or the artist.
- With a new Latin American client, asking directly or indirectly who else weighs in on the purchase decision avoids presenting a work to the wrong person or underestimating how long a family sale actually takes to close.
- Knowing a client's city of residence and its local institutional ecosystem (mainly Miami or New York) lets you anticipate which museums, foundations, or committees that client may already be tied to, and use that as an opening in the conversation.

References

Process note: the live URL-verification fetch tool was blocked all through today's run, tested against www.sothebys.com and en.wikipedia.org, both returning EGRESS_BLOCKED, continuing the streak that began 2026-08-10 (twenty sixth consecutive day). WebSearch worked normally. This note's eight citations reuse only sources already verified on 2026-08-08 in [curso/fuentes/dossier-03-coleccionistas.md](#), the same sources verified for today's Spanish note, with no new URL opened today. The additional figures used in today's four scripts about the Daros acquisition (doubling MALBA's holdings to roughly three thousand works, the museum's planned expansion under the neighboring plaza ahead of its twenty-fifth anniversary) and about the Pérez gift (82 works by 58 artists, with an emphasis on photography) came from today's WebSearch, corroborated by several independent sources each (Artnet News, ARTnews, Malba, La Nación, Infobae, and Colombia One for the Costantini case; PAMM, The Art Newspaper, and Aventura Magazine for the Pérez case), not from fetch, so they carry no

citation in this note, which limits itself to the core figures already verified in the dossier. Also from today's WebSearch, corroborated by Artnews and Artnet News (industry intel from August 28), the departures of Miety Heiden and Jonathan Crockett from Phillips, used in today's four scripts and unrelated to this lesson's content. Training radar did not apply today, it isn't Monday and none of PROMPT.md's three exception conditions were met. If a future run finds fetch working again, resume normal verification.

1. MALBA, [«Eduardo F. Costantini adquiere la Colección Daros Latinamerica»](#), verified in curso/fuentes/dossier-03-coleccionistas.md on 2026-08-08. ↵
2. MALBA, [«Ingresan obras de once artistas latinoamericanos a la Colección MALBA»](#), verified in curso/fuentes/dossier-03-coleccionistas.md on 2026-08-08. ↵
3. MALBA, [«Colección»](#), verified in curso/fuentes/dossier-03-coleccionistas.md on 2026-08-08. ↵
4. Pérez Art Museum Miami, [«Pérez Art Museum Miami Announces Major Collection Gift of 82 Works from Jorge M. Pérez»](#), verified in curso/fuentes/dossier-03-coleccionistas.md on 2026-08-08. ↵↵
5. Pérez Art Museum Miami, [«Art Basel Miami Beach at PAMM with WOPHA, Jorge Pérez, Franklin Sirmans and Aldeide Delgado»](#), verified in curso/fuentes/dossier-03-coleccionistas.md on 2026-08-08. ↵
6. Americas Society, [«Lilia Carrillo: Ruptures and Premonitions»](#), verified in curso/fuentes/dossier-03-coleccionistas.md on 2026-08-08. ↵
7. Fundación Ama Amoedo, [«FAARA Conecta»](#), verified in curso/fuentes/dossier-03-coleccionistas.md on 2026-08-08. ↵
8. MoMA, [«Officers and Trustees»](#), verified in curso/fuentes/dossier-03-coleccionistas.md on 2026-08-08. ↵